

Leave Policy

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out the paid and unpaid leave available to all permanent employees of Nimbus Technologies. It applies from the first day of employment unless stated otherwise. Contractors and agency staff are covered by their own agreements and are out of scope.

2. Annual leave entitlement

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Part-time employees receive a pro-rata entitlement calculated on contracted hours. Employees who join part way through the year accrue 2.08 days for each complete month of service.

After five years of continuous service, entitlement increases to 27 days. After ten years it increases to 30 days. The increase takes effect from the January following the service anniversary.

3. Carry-forward of unused leave

Employees may carry forward a maximum of 5 unused annual leave days into the following calendar year. Carried-forward days must be taken by 31 March of that year, after which they lapse and are not paid out.

Carry-forward above 5 days is permitted only where the employee was prevented from taking leave by business demands, and requires written approval from both the line manager and the HR Business Partner before 31 December.

Unused leave is not paid in lieu except on termination of employment, where it is paid at the basic daily rate.

4. Booking annual leave

Leave is requested through the HR Portal and must be approved by the line manager before travel is booked. The required notice is twice the length of the leave requested, with a minimum of five working days. Requests of ten consecutive days or more require four weeks' notice.

A manager may decline a request where team cover cannot be arranged. A declined request must be answered within five working days with a reason.

No more than 40 per cent of a team may be on leave at the same time. During the financial year-end period, 15 March to 5 April, leave in the Finance department is granted only in exceptional circumstances.

5. Sick leave

Employees receive up to 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Absence of three consecutive days or more requires a medical certificate. Absence must be reported to the line manager before 10:00 on the first day, by telephone rather than message where possible.

Sick leave does not accrue and cannot be carried forward. Long-term absence beyond 10 days moves to the company sick pay scheme, which pays full salary for a further 8 weeks followed by statutory pay.

6. Parental leave

Primary caregivers receive 26 weeks of paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive 8 weeks of paid parental leave, which may be taken in up to three blocks within the first year. Both are available after 26 weeks of continuous service.

Adoption leave is granted on the same terms as parental leave. Employees returning from parental leave may request a phased return of up to eight weeks at reduced hours on full pay.

7. Other leave

Compassionate leave of up to 5 paid days is available on the death of an immediate family member. Marriage leave is 3 paid days, available once during employment. Examination leave of up to 5 days per year is available for company-approved study.

Unpaid leave of up to three months may be requested after two years of service and requires director approval. Benefits continue during unpaid leave but annual leave does not accrue.

8. Public holidays

Employees receive the public holidays of their work location. Where an employee is required to work a public holiday, they receive a day in lieu, to be taken within three months.